

Tosei gusoku (modern armour)
Samurai body armour (*tosei gusoku*) was largely constructed from bamboo, cloth, and metal. Unlike medieval armour, the Japanese example was much lighter, which provided for ease of movement but compromised protection. The armour had to be lightweight because the samurai would often engage in hand-to-hand combat, requiring fast and precise movements. The chest plate is one piece of metal while the arms and neck armour are composed of small pieces of metal bound together with strings.